

The environmental impact of AI art

Posted by u/valonianfool • 0 points • 2 comments

Is the environmental impact of AI art of any significance when considering the ethics of using AI?

I've read posts that compare the impact of AI generators to other things like agriculture, saying that the water and energy use is a "drop in the bucket" in comparison, and that impacts vary by place, a "datacenter in Tucson probably causes more damage than one in the PNW".

I've also read that when run locally, "the power it takes to generate an image is far less than the power my laptop would consume in the time it'll take me to draw the same image."

What are your thoughts? To what extent is the environmental impact of AI a threat?

Comments

u/SeriousNewspaper1189 • 1 points • 2025-12-19 17:58 UTC

Anybody worried about water cooling AI is completely ignorant to the lifecycle of water

u/DaySuitable4034 • 1 points • 2025-12-17 05:27 UTC

Fun fact : one pencil is 150 gallons of water. Think about that. Now Ai just uses water cooling so uhhhh way less

u/brothegaminghero • 0 points • 2025-12-19 13:59 UTC

I don't know how your managing to go through a entire pencil while drawing a picture.

Also this argument is falacios, your comparing the production water use of a pencil to the operation water use of a data center. If the comparison was fair you'd include the water use involved in the production of the every component used in the servers.

u/Rubber_Rake • 5 points • 2025-12-17 01:57 UTC

To put this idea into a perspective:

In Texas, an Ai center told nearby residents to take shorter showers, in response to how march water was being used.

<https://m.economictimes.com/news/international/us/texas-ai-data-centers-water-usage-texas-ai-centers-guzzle-463-million-gallons-now-residents-are-asked-to-cut-back-on-showers-ai->

They use water on a scale where the amount we can take out of the earth isn't enough for the AI and the humans to live as they are